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March 3, 2026

The Honorable JB Pritzker
Governor
207 Statehouse
Springfield, Illinois 62706

Dear Governor Pritzker:

As announced in your recent State of the State Address, the "Building Up Illinois Developments" (BUILD) plan is conceptually set forth in a series of legislative proposals that have been introduced as bills in both chambers of the Illinois General Assembly. In their current form, the Illinois Municipal League (IML) is opposed to each bill due to their individual and combined preemption of municipal authority.

Zoning and land use authority are issues at the heart of local control. So, too, is the provision of well-planned, safe and affordable housing for a community's residents, since local officials are the closest representatives to those residents and can best articulate short-term and long-term local perspectives. A one-size-fits-all approach on this topic simply does not work.

As the statewide association representing all 1,294 cities, villages and towns across the state, IML respectfully requests to be included in all future conversations, legislative working group meetings and/or other discussions that pertain to the BUILD plan and as relate to municipal authority and local implementation of possible legislative outcomes involving your proposal.

Please feel welcome to contact me directly by phone (c: 618-201-7320; w: 217-525-1220) or by email (bcole@iml.org) as those meetings and discussions are anticipated or scheduled. We look forward to working together on this issue. Thanks.

Yours very truly,

BRAD COLE
Chief Executive Officer

c: Senate President Don Harmon
Senate Republican Leader John Curran
Speaker of the House Emanuel "Chris" Welch
House Republican Leader Tony McCombie
IML Board of Directors

ILLINOIS MUNICIPAL LEAGUE

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